

Six Popular and Easy-to-Use Android Developer Tools *for Windows*

The popularity of the Android OS has soared with smartphones and handheld computing devices becoming mainstream. While Android is a Linux OS, it is flexible enough to have developer tools based on Windows. This article discusses a few important Android developer tools for Windows.



Android is a Linux based OS designed primarily for touchscreen mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets. It goes without saying that the operating system has developed a lot in the last 15 years, and has perhaps become the most popular OS for mobile phones.

Here are some of the basics of Android applications:

1. Android apps have one or more application components (activities, services, content providers and broadcast receivers).
2. Each component performs a different role in the overall behaviour of the app, and each one can be activated individually (even by other applications).
3. The *manifest* file must declare all components in the application and should also declare all app requirements, such as the version of Android required and any other hardware configurations.

4. Non-code application resources (images, strings, layout files, etc) should include alternatives for different device configurations (such as different strings for different languages).

A few basic features of Android are:

1. It enables reuse and replacement of components.
2. It is optimised for mobile devices and tablets.
3. It is based on the Open Source Web Kit engine.
4. It is powered by a custom 2D graphics library, and 3D graphics is based on the OpenGL ES 1.0 application.

Android developer tools based on Windows

There are many developer tools available for developing Android apps. This article will talk about the important and easily available ones for Windows.